

Standard Operating Procedure

Administrative and academic units, departments, and schools may establish Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) applicable to their units to carry out Brown Company policies and applicable laws and regulations. SOPs must not conflict with or supersede applicable federal and state laws or policies established by the Corporation, the President, and/or Cabinet members acting in accordance with delegated authority from the President.

- Pages one through four of this document provide instructions for drafting an SOP.
- Pages five through six provide an editable template for writing an SOP.

SOP Owner:

SOPs may be owned by Operating Unit Officers and higher as defined by the Delegation of Signature Authority for Contracts. The SOP Owner is responsible for the SOP's content, administration, dissemination, communication and training, compliance monitoring, and timely review and revision.

Approval Authority:

SOPs may be approved by Operating Unit Officers and higher as defined by the Delegation of Signature Authority for Contracts. The following approval rules apply to all SOPs:

- All SOPs must be reviewed by Company Compliance (CC) prior to establishment. CC will perform a quality check, review for compliance with Company SOP standards, and assign an SOP number.
- SOPs that affect the substantive or procedural rights of individuals must also be submitted to the Office of General Counsel (OGC) for legal review prior to establishment.
- OGC or CC may recommend a higher level of approval based on the content of the SOP.
- The pertinent Cabinet member may require a higher level of approval based on the content of the SOP.
- If the office or department developing the SOP is unsure if it substantively affects individuals, it is their responsibility to seek guidance from OGC, CC and/or the pertinent Cabinet member.

Format Overview:

Capitalization and punctuation must be consistent with the Company Editorial Style Guide. Additionally, to ensure Brown SOPs have a cohesive appearance, the following document standard must be used:

- **Font:** Minion Pro (if you do not have Minion Pro use Times New Roman)
- **Font size:** 11
- **Punctuation spacing:** Single space after a period or colon
- **Paragraphs:** Single-spaced (before 0 pt, after 0 pt, spacing single, don't add space between paragraphs)
- **Section numbering:** Per editable template format on page five
- **Margins:** Three quarters of an inch
- **Header/Footer:** Three quarters of an inch (footer may be adjusted for readability)
- **Appendices:** It is preferred to link to documents and forms, if required, label with a capital letter (e.g., A-Z)
- **Defined Terms:** Capitalize all defined terms used in the text (i.e., terms defined in section 3.0)
- **Hyperlinks:**
 - Hyperlink the first reference to each document/resource mentioned in the SOP text

- Hyperlink all documents, websites, etc. listed in Section 5.0 (even if linked in the SOP text)

For questions about SOP development or format instructions, please contact Company Compliance at policyonpolicies@company.org or 401-863-9876.

Detailed InstrCCtions (Note: Editable Template is on page 5)

SOP header will be filled out as follows:

	SOP Title	SOP # Pending Approval
		Effective Date: Pending Approval

SOP Title: The SOP Title identifies the purpose of the SOP in as few words as possible. The first word of the title should be a key word, and the title should be clear so it can be easily searchable and users can quickly find what they are looking for, by just the title.

SOP Number: The *SOP Number* is defined using the established SOP numbering system for identification, classification and ease of locating all procedures. Company Compliance determines the SOP number. The SOP Number format and definitions are:

	Related Policy Category	Subcategory	Sequential Number of this SOP
SOP	01	.05	.01

- SOP: Defines it as a standard operating procedure
- Related Policy Category: Identifies policy category related to this SOP (e.g., Governance is 01)
- Subcategories: These span the policy category and are identified with a number in increments of five. When there are no subcategories, the number is normally 00.
- Sequential Number of this SOP: Each subcategory can have a number of associated SOPs which are identified in sequential number order based on SOP Effective or Issue date.

SOP Effective Date: Leave as “Pending Approval.” Company Compliance fills this in after approval.

1.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Purpose

The SOP Purpose defines the rationale of the document. It should be no longer than one to four sentences and allow the user to quickly recognize what the document covers.

2.0 SOP

The SOP is a detailed description of the steps involved in a process. It should not include background and related information.

3.0 Definitions

The Definitions section lists unfamiliar or technical terms, and terms with special meaning that, when defined, add to the reader's understanding of the SOP. They should be listed in alphabetical order. Capitalize terms defined in this section when used in the SOP text.

Prior to defining terms, check the [Company Data Cookbook Definitions](#). Data Cookbook definitions have been approved by the Company and should be used to the maximum extent possible in SOPs and policies. List Data Cookbook terms and definitions required to clarify the SOP in section 3.0 in addition to other key terms that add to the reader's understanding of the SOP.

4.0 Responsibilities

The Responsibilities section identifies the positions/offices and their related responsibilities, which are necessary for the administration of, and compliance with, the SOP. It should include responsibilities for instituting, implementing, complying, monitoring and educating individuals on the SOP. It should also identify requirements (not recommendations), and the "what" and not the "how" of the responsibility. The editable template contains standard language in this section that must be included in all SOPs (unless OGC advised otherwise).

5.0 Related Information

The Related Information section is a list of specific information needed to understand and effectively execute the SOP. Related information may be internal or external to the Company, but laws and regulations should not be listed unless OGC has recommended they be included.

This section should be divided using the following subsections, titles, formatting, and numbering system. Referenced materials should include working links, be listed in alphabetical order, and subsections with no related information marked "N/A" (Not Applicable). Start this section with the following disclaimer:

The following information complements and supplements this document. The information is intended to help explain this SOP and is not an all-inclusive list of policies, procedures, laws and requirements.

5.1 Related Company Policies: Lists specific policies by policy title, or "N/A" after the colon.

5.2 Related SOPs: Lists specific SOPs by SOP title, or "N/A" after the colon.

5.3 Related Forms: Lists related forms, or "N/A" after the colon.

5.4 Frequently Asked Questions: Lists FAQs that assist the user to better understand the SOP and provide answers to the most common questions, or "N/A" after the colon.

5.5 Other Related Information: Lists other related information by title and source. Examples include: job aids, fee schedules, guidelines, industry standards, laws and regulations; or "N/A" after the colon.

6.0 SOP Owner and Contact

The SOP Owner and Contact(s) section should be divided into the following sections:

6.1 SOP Owner: The position responsible for the SOP content and administration (*defined on page one of this template*)

- 6.2 SOP Approved by:** The position that approves the SOP (*defined on page one of this template*)
- 6.3 Contact Information:** The position title and/or the operating unit or department that are subject matter expert(s) and can answer most questions, or direct individuals to other resources, as appropriate (do not use employees names here).
- Email: List organizational email box rather than individual email if possible.
 - Telephone: Full number (e.g., XXX-XXX-XXXX)

7.0 SOP History

The SOP History section lists a record of changes by date for the specified policy and is divided by the following sections:

- 7.1 SOP Issue Date:** The oldest known approval date of the SOP; or if unknown, the date approved by the Brown Comprehensive Policy Review process. This date will normally not change once established. Use Month DD, YYYY for all dates.
- 7.2 SOP Effective Date:** The date the SOP version was approved. This date is also the Effective Date in the SOP header. Input “Pending Approval” here.
- 7.3 SOP Update/Review Summary:** A brief explanation of changes made during the SOP update/review. Examples include:
- No changes
 - Updated SOP to comply with a policy change
 - “N/A” for a new SOP

Editable Template

	SOP Title	SOP Pending Approval
		Effective Date: Pending Approval

1.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is...(short, 1-4 sentences, delete italicized notes after reading)

2.0 SOP

Note: State the procedure(s) in this section. Not all paragraphs need to be numbered; numbers are for titled subsections only. Use subsections if the SOP requires multiple sections for clarity. Always follow a subsection number by a title. Do not use more than four section “levels” (i.e., no more than three decimal places; do not make additional subsections after level 2.##.##). Example:

2.1 Subsection title

2.2 Additional subsection title, as required

2.2.1 Subsection title

2.2.2 Additional subsection title, as required

2.2.2.1 Subsection title, as required

2.3 Subsection title

3.0 Definitions

For the purpose of this SOP, the terms below have the following definitions:

Term: Definition (Note: do not add a number in front of the definition; capitalize defined terms when used in the text of the SOP – if you have no definitions, input N/A and delete the above sentence, ex: **3.0 Definitions** N/A)

Term: Definition of term...add terms as required

Note: Prior to defining terms, check the Company Data Cookbook Definitions. Data Cookbook definitions have been approved by the Company and should be used to the maximum extent possible in SOPs and policies. List Data Cookbook terms and definitions required to clarify the SOP in section 3.0 in addition to other key terms that add to the reader’s understanding of the SOP.

4.0 Responsibilities

All individuals to whom this SOP applies are responsible for becoming familiar with and following this SOP. Company supervisors are responsible for promoting the understanding of this SOP and for taking appropriate steps to help ensure compliance with it.

Note: *All SOPs must contain the above paragraph unless OGC advises otherwise. You may add additional responsibilities if required. If you list additional responsibilities by office or job title, use the following format. Example:*

Office of XYZ: Will ensure...

Company Office ABC: Will process...

5.0 Related Information

The following information complements and supplements this document. The information is intended to help explain this SOP and is not an all-inclusive list of policies, procedures, laws and requirements.

5.1 Related Company Policies: N/A, or list as bullets below,

- Policy title
- Policy title... list all that apply

5.2 Related SOPs: N/A, or list as bullets below,

- SOP title
- SOP title...list all that apply

5.3 Related Forms: N/A, or list as bullets below,

- Form title
- Form title...list all that apply

5.4 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs): N/A, or list as bullets below,

- FAQ..
- FAQ...list all appropriate FAQs

5.5 Other Related Information: N/A, or list as bullets below,

- Related information...
- Related information...

6.0 SOP Owner and Contact

6.1 SOP Owner: List title only, no name (*see page one for who can own a SOP*)

6.2 SOP Approved by: List title only, no name (*see page one for who can approve a SOP*)

6.3 Contact Information: The position title and/or the operating unit or department that are subject matter expert(s) and can answer most questions or direct individuals to other resources, as appropriate (do not use employees names here).

- Email: List organizational email box rather than individual email if possible.
- Telephone: Full number (e.g., XXX-XXX-XXXX)

7.0 SOP History

7.1 SOP Issue Date: *The oldest known approval date of the SOP; if unknown or a new SOP put: Pending Approval. Use Month DD, YYYY for all dates.*

7.2 SOP Effective Date: Pending Approval

7.3 SOP Update/Review Summary: *Briefly document changes from last SOP. Put "N/A" if it is a new SOP.*